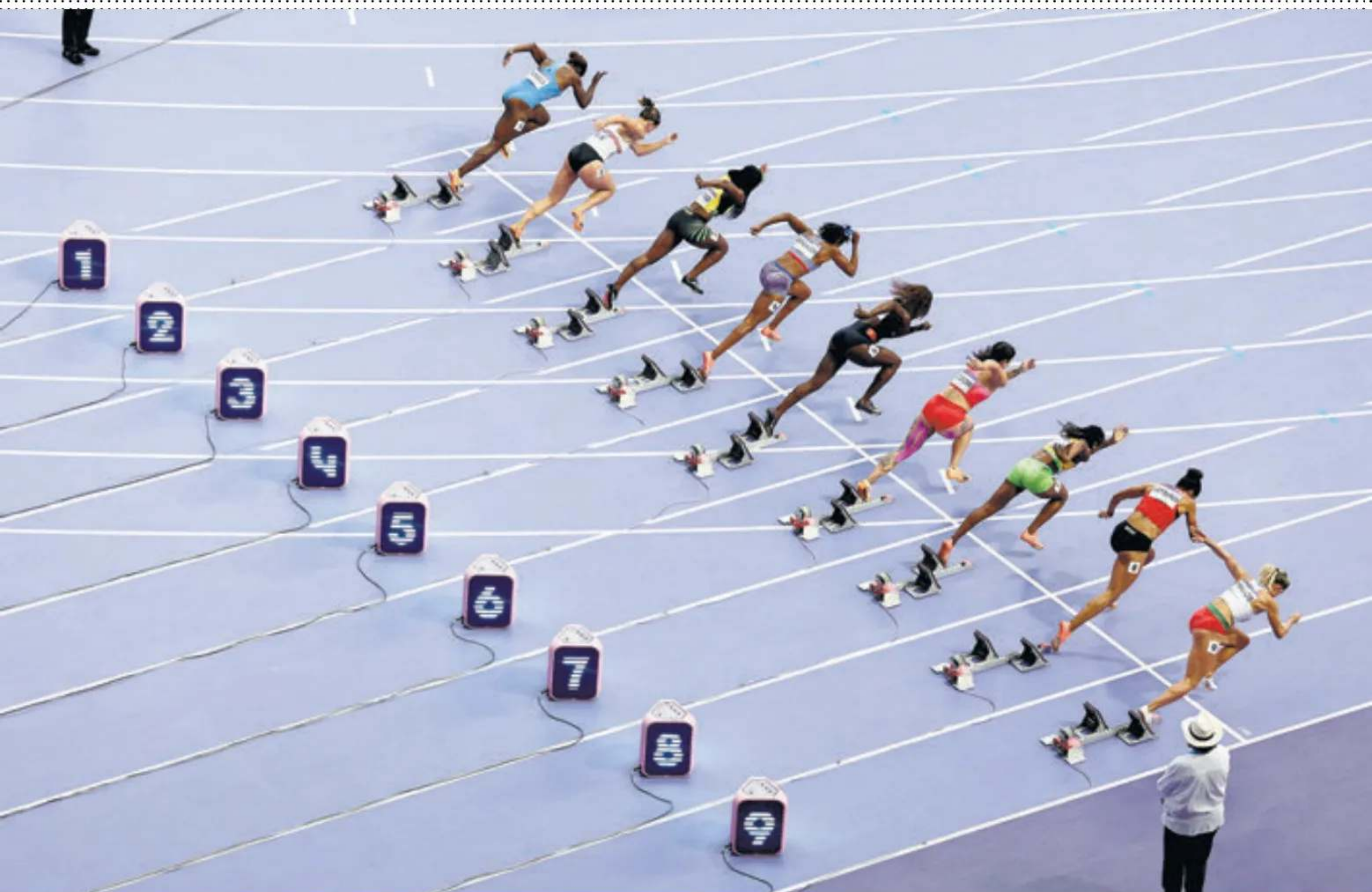




✦ Magnesium sources: Nuts, seeds, dark chocolate (best taken before bed for muscle recovery).

2. Omega-3s and Calcium:

Omega-3s and calcium are essential for reducing inflammation and supporting bone health, particularly during the high-intensity phases such as ovulation.

✦ Omega-3 sources: Fatty fish, chia seeds and walnuts.

✦ Calcium sources: Dairy products, tofu and leafy greens (best consumed in the morning or evening).

Bonus tips

1. Add red clover tea to your diet:

Red clover contains isoflavones, which may help relieve menstrual symptoms like hot flashes and night sweats.

✦ Pre-cycle: Start drinking red clover tea 1-2 weeks before your period to ease premenstrual symptoms like bloating, mood swings, and breast tenderness.

✦ Post-cycle: Continue drinking it throughout your cycle if beneficial.

✦ How to prepare: Steep 1-2 teaspoons of dried red clover flowers in hot water for 5-7 minutes. Strain and enjoy, hot or cold. Add honey for sweetness.

2. Include Vitamin E-rich foods:

Vitamin E can reduce period pain, limit blood loss, and regulate your cycle.

✦ A study showed that Vitamin E supplements eased painful cramps within two months.

✦ Sources: Almonds, avocados, broccoli, and spinach are great options for women.

Understanding the impact of the menstrual cycle on performance is crucial for providing meaningful support to female athletes. Unlike men, women experience hormonal fluctuations throughout the month that can significantly affect both their physical and mental states. Some days, your daughter, sister, or athlete may feel unstoppable, while on others, she might struggle with fatigue, discomfort, or even pain. Recognising these natural

Customised brilliance: By tailoring workouts and nutrition to the different phases of the menstrual cycle, women can enhance their performance, improve recovery, and achieve better results. GETTYIMAGES

fluctuations and offering both emotional and practical support can make a profound difference in her athletic journey. Encourage her to listen to her body, adjust her training accordingly, and focus on nutrition that supports her through each phase of the cycle. Whether it's being there when she's feeling low during her menstrual phase or cheering her on when her energy peaks during ovulation, your understanding and compassion can give her the extra boost she needs to thrive.

By acknowledging the unique needs of female athletes, we can create an environment where they not only excel but feel supported in every aspect of their journey.